

Your name:

# The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2020

## Round 2



### Problem 1. Taiwan Paiwan (20 marks)

Paiwan is a minority language in Taiwan/Republic of China, spoken by around 66,000 native speakers in the southern region of the island. One of the major components of Paiwan syntax is “focus”, which applies to the new piece of information that the sentence is conveying. In English, this can be represented by sentences like “It is ***the dog*** which the man likes”: in this example, ***the dog*** is focused.



Below are some sentences in Paiwan with their English translations. Sentence elements in ***italics*** are focused. (The digraph **dj** represents a single sound. The word **langedaen** in sentence 8 is actually **langedain**, but this was edited for the sake of simplicity.)

| Paiwan                                               | English                                                       |
|------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. kanan nua uqalay tua kuka a quma nua tsakaw       | The man eats the chicken in <b><i>the thief's field</i></b> . |
| 2. qmatup tua vavuy a kuvatu                         | <b><i>My dog</i></b> hunts the pig.                           |
| 3. djavisen nua tsemas a kukama                      | The spirit snatches <b><i>my father</i></b> .                 |
| 4. sitarang nua uqalay a vuluq                       | The man protects (it) with <b><i>the spear</i></b> .          |
| 5. qatupen nua suvavuy i tua umaq a alak nua vavaian | Your pig hunts <b><i>the woman's child</i></b> in the house.  |
| 6. kman tua kuka a tsemas                            | <b><i>The spirit</i></b> eats the chicken.                    |
| 7. djavisan nua pulingaw tua vuluq a gadu            | The shaman snatches the spear in <b><i>the mountain</i></b> . |
| 8. langedaen nua sivitay a qaya-qayam                | The soldier hears <b><i>the bird</i></b> .                    |

Answer the questions on the next page on your answer sheet.

Your name:

# The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2020

## Round 2



**Q1.1.** How would you say these sentences in Paiwan?

9. The man protects the field with **the dog**.
10. Your shaman hunts my bird in **the spirit's mountain**.
11. **The woman** snatches the pig.

Now look at the following question-answer dialogues. The first answer has been translated for you.

| Question                                 | Answer                                                                             |
|------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 12. inu a tmarang a tsakaw?              | tmarang a tsakaw i tua quma<br><i>The thief who protects (it) is in the field.</i> |
| 13. anema a siqatup nua sukama tua watu? | siqatup nua kukama tua watu a kuvuluq                                              |
| 14. anema a sudjavisen?                  | kudjavisen a qaya-qayam nua vavaian                                                |
| 15. inu a kanan nua uqalay?              | kanan nua uqalay a gadu                                                            |

**Q1.2.** Based on these examples, translate the following responses into English, underlining focused elements, and saying what questions (in Paiwan) could have prompted them.

16. susitarang tua qaya-qayam nua pulingaw a tsemas
17. kanan nua uqalay a vavuy i tua gadu
18. kuqatupan tua suvatu a kuquma